

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Acting 3-4 emphasizes working with classical texts and heightened language. Using plays by Shakespeare and other classical playwrights, players will learn to join the emotional, physical and imaginative life of the role with the technical skills needed to express that character to its fullest. This is achieved through foundation work and applying the basic tenets of acting to the acting of plays in verse: making strong choices that are grounded in the text, establishing a connection to the scene partner, listening and responding to the given circumstances and to what is happening in the scene. Players will endeavor to develop their physical and vocal instruments to meet the demands of the material. Through in depth study of movement techniques and other physical work, you will further focus your techniques on inhabiting the world of the play. Work in voice and speech will also commence. Primary focus will be on practical methodologies to heightened language and increasing the range of the players' capacity to embody and clarify action through their speaking.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

This class will take you through an intensive year of text analysis and play exploration bringing into focus the necessity for sharpened acting tools when approaching a Shakespearean text. By the end of the year, you should have acquired the skills to:

- To speak the text clearly and intelligently and yet maintain an integral sense of truth and believable human speech patterns, as discovered through the text of the First Folio. That is, to allow the text to affect your own emotions without imposing an emotional response on top of the text, and yet to be able to speak it without 'singing' it in high 'classical' artifice.
- To be well enough informed to understand that within the text lies the foundation of all dramatic and poetic literature written since the publication of the First Folio, and the basis for a contemporary understanding of the human experience.
- Discover & prepare any monologue and or scene from The Complete Works which should come your way either as audition or production.
- To ably critique and fully experience any production of Shakespeare that your travels bring you in contact with.

C L A S S E T I Q U E T T E

T A R D I N E S S

There are always days when the car won't start, when there is no parking, when the cat becomes violently ill five minutes before leaving home, when you forgot to turn on your alarm or left the volume on your phone at zero. I experience them. You experience them. They should be exceptions rather than rules.

A T T E N D A N C E

(See above also). In four years of college, I missed not one single theatre class, and in twenty years of professional experience, I have missed not one single rehearsal or performance, and have always been prepared and memorized on time. It is your personal obligation to keep yourself healthy. If you feel sickness approaching, don't go to a party and stay out until 4am. Take care of yourself. Obviously I don't want you in class if you are spewing germs into the breathing space, but be prudent as to what constitutes sickness.

P R E P A R A T I O N

Inspiration does not often descend from a magical cloud of creativity and smite the ready and waiting artist. The best work comes as a result of plain hard work. I understand how full your schedules are. I sympathize... only so much as I am required to in polite society. Truthfully, I say welcome to real life. Get over it. Figure it out, or be devoured. When I say lines are due to be memorized, they must be memorized. When we stage a scene, I expect to see it developed, personally owned, or even rejected for a better choice when we next return to it in class. Unless your entire family has been blighted with some massive personal tragedy, there are no excuses. This is an advanced course. It's time to prove you belong here.

G R A C E & G E N E R O S I T Y

There will be days in class where you are not the focus, despite your obvious genius and gifts constantly worthy of sharing with those of us less fortunate. As boring as it may seem, you must watch and learn. I may be addressing an acting issue you share with others, and by watching the breakthroughs of others, you will always learn about yourself. Consequently I expect you to always be available to the work of your class mates, and generous with your emotions and intellect while they are working. Additionally, the classroom should be a safe zone for you to take risks and fail in supportive arms. If you laugh AT each other, stand back and watch my fireworks. If you laugh in delight WITH discoveries, then expect more and expect your own work to be received with as much generosity. Be sensitive to the actions and emotions of others and how your own behavior affects the group.

E G O & P R O F E S S I O N A L I S M

Professionalism. It's an overused word, I know, and it means a thousand different things to a thousand different professionals. To me, the word ultimately encapsulates the battle between the Ego and the Work. If the energies you bring into the room find themselves focusing on personal issues: "I need attention today because I'm feeling low"; "Please like me! How do you like me now? Do you like me better when I stand like this?"; "I'm not going to take your note, because my father and/or mother criticized me a lot when I was a kid"; "You don't like my acting

choice? Does that make me a bad person?"; "Do you think I'm talented?" etc. etc, All these issues of self focus will ultimately spill into the way you work, the way you interact, and everything mentioned so far in this syllabus. You can bat away criticism with a thousand and one excuses, but it won't make you a better artist. Shakespeare, above all other writers, demands the naked soul, and self promotion only gets in the way. His ideas are always better than yours. However, his writings can open you up to personal vistas unimagined and undreamed. Maintain that Delicate Balance and fly. Bring ego into the class room, wear it as a suit of Armor, and sink.

EATING & DRINKING IN CLASS

Eating? Don't. No food during class. Sorry. No exceptions. Drinking? Beverages may be drunk from non-leaking bottles, and coffee or other hot beverages in mugs.

YOUR GRADE

I will not be evaluating your talent. Time will take care of that for all of us. I will be evaluating your work ethics and your progress. A little thing can affect the whole.

Further, in depth grading procedures and breakdowns can be found on the Class ONENote and TEAMS page in your Office365 Suite.

ONENote Classroom Notebook:	7th Theatre Prod Intro - S1
Teams Page (Connected to ONENote)	7th Acting 3 - S1

NOTE: Links to the above pages can be found on my SWAY page (The New Swift sight) from the Classroom websites link at <https://www.tacomaschools.org/sota/pages/contact.aspx>

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PLAGIARISM AND/OR CHEATING

are not condoned by Tacoma School of the Arts. A student who cheats or plagiarizes the works of others is at risk of receiving a failing grade for the course in which such action takes place.

THE AMERICANS WITH DISABILITIES ACT OF 1990

is designed to ensure that students with disabilities have an equal opportunity to access academic programs and successfully complete their studies. Tacoma School of the Arts is committed to providing accessibility to all students. Any student with special needs must complete a self-identification form available in the counseling office. This information will remain strictly confidential.